FOR ORGANIZERS

Inclusive meeting checklist

School meetings often center families who already feel at home in institutional spaces: people who speak English, have flexible time, and feel confident raising a hand in a room of strangers. These changes to how you set up the room, greet people, and run the meeting make belonging real, not just stated.

Before the meeting

- [ ] **Send a pre-read in every language.** Minutes, budget summaries, and anything being voted on. One page per item, so no one votes on something they haven't understood.
- [ ] **Reach out personally.** Call or text in families' home languages, not just flyers.
- [ ] **Let facilitators shape the agenda** before it's final.

Arrival and setup

- [ ] **One greeter per language** at the door, speaking that language first. Not a sign-in table: a person whose job is welcome.
- [ ] **Color-dot name tags** so people can show their language without reading or writing anything.
- [ ] **Clusters, not rows.** Rows say information flows one way. Clusters say conversation.
- [ ] **A table question** on every cluster, in every language.
- [ ] **Post the meeting map** where everyone can see it.

During the meeting

- [ ] **Open with three voices,** one per language. Name who's in the room and why it matters they're there.
- [ ] **Small groups before business.** One grounding question in home-language groups, then one idea and one question back to the room, in people's actual words.
- [ ] **Pause before big votes** so people can ask questions in their language first.
- [ ] **Protect mutual aid and open forum.** If you run long, cut announcements, not dialogue.
- [ ] **Don't make ideas into chores.** Raising an idea shouldn't mean you have to run it.
- [ ] **Close with three voices** and the next meeting date.

After the meeting

- [ ] **Answer every question,** in every language, by next meeting.
- [ ] **Debrief with facilitators:** what worked, what felt awkward, whose voice we didn't hear.

Facilitators are peers, not translators. Ask trusted families who others already go to for help. Frame the role as "help your neighbors feel comfortable and heard." Pay them if you can, and never leave them alone: a check-in before, a co-facilitator during, and a debrief after.